GRADWRITE

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PACK 8

6-Part Blitz

1. What term is used to refer to people that experience romantic attraction, as opposed to aromantic people?
    A: **allo**romantic
2. The region of Kimberley is located in the north of what state, Australia's largest?
    A: **Western Australia**
3. What German mathematician names the first known example of a function that is continuous everywhere but differentiable nowhere?
    A: Karl **Weierstrass**
4. To what genus of tree does Centurion, the largest mountain ash in Tasmania, belong?
    A: **eucalyptus**
5. What holiday's service ends with the Ne'ilah, or closing prayer, and the blowing of a shofar?
    A: **Yom Kippur**
6. In 2019, what country became the most recent to change its capital city when it moved it from Bujumbura to Gitega?
    A: **Burundi**

Set of 4: Abbreviated Brand Names

7. MINI and Rolls-Royce are subsidiaries of what German automobile manufacturer?
    A: **BMW** AG (accept: **BMW Group**, **Bayerische Moteren Werke** AG)
8. What do the first two letters stand for in the name of the lubricant WD-40?
    A: **water displacement** (accept: **water** AND **displacement**)
9. Bruce Murrie and Forrest Mars are the namesakes of what brand of chocolate candy?
    A: **M&M's**
10. What U.S. state is found in the full name of 3M, its namesake "mining and manufacturing company"?
    A: **Minnesota**

Pyramid

11.
Part 1: What island contains Freshkills Park, the site of the largest landfill in the world until its 2001 closure?
Part 2: This island, which lies across the Arthur Kill from Union County, is coextensive with Richmond County.
Part 3: Most Black and Hispanic residents of this island live north of Interstate 278, which passes over the Verrazzano-Narrows Bridge.
Part 4: This island is sometimes called the "forgotten borough", as it is the least populous of the five that make up New York City.

A: **Staten** Island

Set of 3: Contronyms
Given two opposite definitions of the same word, provide the word.

14. What word can mean "to attach" or "to cut or trim"?
A: **clip**
15. What verb can either mean "to give official permission" or "to impose a penalty"?
A: **sanction**
16. "To endure a tough situation" and "to be slowly worn away" are both definitions of what verb?
A: **weather**

Double Jump

17. In 313 CE, emperors Licinius and Constantine I issued what decree granting Christians freedom from persecution in the Roman Empire?
A: **Edict of Milan**
18. Christianity became the state religion of the Roman Empire following the 380 issue of what other edict by Theodosius I?
A: Edict of **Thessalonica**

Double Jump

19. Emmy Rossum portrays Christine Daaé ["DIE-ay"] in a film adaptation of what longest-running Broadway musical?
A: *The **Phantom of the Opera***
20. What actor and ex-wife of Andrew Lloyd Webber originated the role of Christine on Broadway and on the West End?
A: Sarah **Brightman**

5-Part Mystery Link

21. Into what animal does Rothbart curse Odette to transform in a namesake Tchaikovsky ballet?
A: **swan**
22. According to German legend, what profession was held by a multi-coloured exterminator who would magically lure rats out of Hamelin?
A: pied **piper** (prompt: musician)
23. What singer recorded the EP Te Ao Mārama, consisting of five Māori translations of songs from her album Solar Power?
A: **Lorde** (accept: Ella Marija Lani **Yelich-O'Connor**; but reveal: Lorde)
24. In 2004, what subsidiary of Unilever launched the Campaign for Real Beauty advertisement series?
A: **Dove**

25. What piece of commemorative jewellery is given every year to the front office staff, coaches, and players who win the NBA Finals?

A: championship **ring** (accept: premiership **ring**)

All answers are gifts given in the Twelve Days of Christmas.

END OF FIRST QUARTER

SECOND QUARTER

Splits: Formula One & The Brain

Formula One

26. What McLaren F1 driver, who earned his first win at the Miami Grand Prix, was the runner-up at the 2024 Drivers' Championship?

A: Lando **Norris**

27. What Formula One driver's record-breaking last Monaco Grand Prix victory occurred in 1993, a year before his death at Imola?

A: Ayrton **Senna**

28. For what F1 team does Charles Leclerc drive, alongside his teammate Lewis Hamilton?

A: Scuderia **Ferrari**

29. In what city did a 2011 F1 race become the longest in history due to rain delays and red flags?

A: **Montreal**

The Brain

30. What structure, the largest white matter structure of the brain, allows for communication between the two hemispheres?

A: **corpus callosum**

31. Located in the frontal lobe, what area of the brain responsible for language production is named after a French physician?

A: **Broca**'s area

32. The ions of what two elements are rapidly exchanged through the neuron plasma membrane to induce an action potential?

A: **sodium** AND **potassium** (accept: **Na** AND **K**)

33. What degenerative brain disease is caused by buildup of the tau protein from repeated head trauma, and can only be properly diagnosed after death?

A: **CTE** (accept: **chronic traumatic encephalopathy**)

Set of 3: South African History

34. A three hour speech known as the "I Am Prepared to Die" speech was given by what first president of post-apartheid South Africa?

A: Nelson **Mandela**

35. What name is given to the violent period of unwanted migration in the first half of the 18th century, which is often blamed on the aggression of Shaka Zulu?

A: the **Mfecane** (accept: **Difaqane**, **Lifaqane**, The **Crushing**)

36. The Kruger Telegram was sent in response to what failed British raid, often cited as one of the causes of the Second Boer War?

A: **Jameson** Raid

Set of 4: 2000s TV Shows

37. What TV show set in Stars Hollow follows the lives of mother and daughter Lorelai and Rory?

A: ***Gilmore Girls***

38. What character refers to himself as "Lonely Boy" on his blog *Gossip Girl*?

A: **Dan**iel Humphrey (prompt: Humphrey)

39. What name is given to the trio consisting of Brittany Pierce, Santana Lopez, and Quinn Fabray, often considered the most infamous trio on *Glee*?

A: The **Unholy Trinity**

40. What 2004 TV series stars Matthew Fox, Josh Holloway, and Evangeline Lilly as survivors of Oceanic Flight 815 after they crash on a remote island?

A: ***Lost***

Double Jump

41. What type of creature pursues Lucy Westenra and Mina Harker in a novel by Bram Stoker?

A: **vampire**

42. In what 1872 novella is Laura pursued by the Countess Karnstein, the title vampire, as both prey and as a romantic companion?

A: ***Carmilla***

Double Jump

43. What character declares "I'm never going back, the past is in the past" in the mountains outside Arendelle in "Let It Go?"

A: Queen **Elsa** of Arendelle

44. An "icy force, both foul and fair" is described in what other song sung in the mountains outside Arendelle, the first song on the *Frozen* soundtrack?

A: "**Frozen Heart**"

6-Part Linked Set

45. According to Merriam-Webster, what is the only English word whose American spelling ends in "ck" but whose British spelling ends in "que"?

A: **cheque** (accept: **check**)

46. The election of Alexander Dubček ["doob-CHEK"] in January 1968 kickstarted what period of political reformation and mass protest in Czechoslovakia?

A: **Prague Spring**

47. What physicist names a law linearly relating force exerted to the displacement of a spring?

A: Robert **Hooke**

48. What static letter in ASL can be represented with one hand in a fist with the index finger in a hook shape?

A: **x**

49. Who changed the placement of a shoulder strap after the Paris Salon deemed his *Portrait of Madame X* scandalous?

A: John Singer **Sargent**

50. Flowers spell out the name of what band on the cover of their album *Sgt. Pepper's Lonely Hearts Club Band*?

A: The **Beatles**

END OF FIRST HALF

THIRD QUARTER

Splits: The Far-Right in Modern Europe & Literary Criticism

The Far-Right in Modern Europe

51. What party overtook the Socialist Party to place second in Portugal's 2025 Parliamentary elections?

A: **Chega**

52. In a January 2024 post on X, what leader of the Party for Freedom declared "We hebben een serieus probleem" ["veh HEBB-en een see-ree-US prob-LAYM"] about a proposed law in the Netherlands?

A: Geert **Wilders**

53. What surname is shared by the first leader of the FN, Jean-Marie, and the current French opposition leader, Marine?

A: **Le Pen**

54. In 2011, what party introduced a new constitution that allowed it to consolidate power as the ruling party of Hungary?

A: **Fidesz** - Hungarian Civil Alliance

Literary Criticism

55. Who applied his concept of classic literature forming "skeletons" of conventional myths and metaphors to dissect the narrative of the Bible in a famous lecture series?

A: Northrop **Frye**

56. What critical approach, which places the reader as ultimate authority on a work, was first used by Roland Barthes?

A: "The **Death of the Author**"

57. What specific amenity, alongside 500 pounds a year, must a woman have in order to write fiction, according to an essay by Virginia Woolf?

A: a **room of one's own** (accept: **a room of her own**)

58. To what school of literary criticism did theorists like Walter Benjamin and Theodor Adorno belong?

A: **Frankfurt** School

Set of 4: Types of Rock

59. Hypabyssal rocks form at shallower depths than what mythologically-named class of coarse-grained intrusive igneous rocks, which includes rocks like granite and gabbro?

A: **plutonic** rocks

60. Overwhelming volume and distorted layered guitars characterize what subgenre, popularized by the albums *Souvlaki* and *Loveless*?

A: **shoegaze**

61. What subgenre of rock is known for its androgynous, flamboyant style and includes artists like Queen and David Bowie?

A: **glam** rock (accept: **glitter** rock)

62. Tufa and chalk are both types of what sedimentary rock composed of calcium carbonate?

A: **limestone**

Jailbreak

63. What poet tells her dead father that "there's a stake in your fat black heart" in her poem "Daddy"?
A: Sylvia **Plath**
64. Who was elected in 2024 as the first female president of Mexico?
A: Claudia **Sheinbaum** Pardo
65. What type of plant hosts rhizobium bacteria in its roots, allowing it to replenish nitrogen in soils?
A: **legume** (accept: **bean**)
66. The most recent edition of what citation style guide recommends omitting a source's location of publication, and permits the two major formats author-date and notes and bibliography?
A: *The **Chicago** Manual of Style*
67. What continent contains the greatest number of countries whose flags include the Union Jack?
A: **Oceania** (accept: **Australia**)
68. In Python, what value would be returned by the computation "21 percent 8"?
A: **5**
69. To the east of the Tharsis region along the equator of Mars lies what system of canyons, the largest of its kind in the solar system?
A: **Valles Marineris**
70. On July 28th, 2025, what man was seen at Le Violon sharing a meal with Katy Perry?
A: **Justin Trudeau** (prompt: Trudeau)
71. What trumpeter became the first jazz musician to win the Pulitzer Prize for Music when he won in 1997 for *Blood on the Fields*?
A: Wynton **Marsalis**
72. 1989, 2001, 2013, and 2025 are all the year of what animal in the Chinese zodiac?
A: **snake**
73. What ship completed the Kessel Run in less than 12 parsecs under the command of pilots Chewbacca and Han Solo?
A: ***Millennium Falcon***
74. What city is overlooked by Corcovado Mountain, on top of which stands Christ the Redeemer?
A: **Rio de Janeiro** (prompt: Rio)
75. Which of the four fundamental forces is not described by the Standard Model?
A: **gravity** (accept: **gravitational force**)

END OF THIRD QUARTER

FOURTH QUARTER

Pyramid

76.
Part 1: What actor began her career playing Charlotte in the Broadway production of *13*?
Part 2: A production of *Hairspray Live!* also featuring Dove Cameron and Kristin Chenoweth starred this actor as Penny Pingleton.
Part 3: This actor, who began a relationship with a castmate during the production of her latest movie, played the enthusiastic but oblivious Cat Valentine on Nickelodeon's *Victorious*.
Part 4: This actor clutches the finger of her co-star, Cynthia Erivo, in an interview promoting the movie adaptation of *Wicked*, in which she played Glinda the Good Witch.

A: Ariana **Grande**-Butera

Set of 3: Social Networks

79. Playwright John Guare claimed that what number of social connections are needed to connect any two people in the world?

A: **6** social connections (accept: **6** degrees of separation)

80. After finding out that his shares were diluted, what character smashes Mark Zuckerberg's laptop in *The Social Network*?

A: **Eduardo** **Saverin** (accept either underlined part)

81. What name is given in mathematics to a complete induced subgraph, a term that in sociology is used to describe a small group of individuals who all share similar interests?

A: **clique**

Set of 4: Art Museums

82. What national museum houses *The Milkmaid* and *The Night Watch*, along with other works by famous Dutch artists?

A: **Rijksmuseum** ["RIKES-myoo-ZEE-um"]

83. In what modern art museum does Gwen Stacy face off against a Renaissance-era Vulture from an alternate timeline in *Spider-Man: Across the Spider-Verse*?

A: Solomon R. **Guggenheim** Museum New York

84. Michelangelo's original David sculpture is housed in what Florentine museum?

A: Galleria dell'**Accademia** di Firenze (accept: Gallery of the **Academy** of Florence)

85. Out of what material are the triangular and diamond-shaped tiles that I. M. Pei used to construct the Louvre Pyramid made?

A: **glass**

15-Part Blitz

86. The Strait of Messina connects the Ionian Sea with what other sea, which is also connected to the Ligurian Sea by the Corsica Channel?

A: **Tyrrhenian** Sea

87. What fruit was preserved and venerated as part of a namesake "fever" during the Cultural Revolution?

A: **mango**

88. Concerns over exploitation are behind the controversy surrounding the use of what animal as an ingredient in Kaestur Hàkarl, a national dish of Iceland?

A: Greenland **shark**

89. What name is given to large boulders of silcrete found across southern England, which were most notably used to construct the large outer ring of standing stones at Stonehenge?

A: **sarsen** stones

90. Credited with coining the term "software engineering", what computer scientist received the Presidential Medal of Freedom for her work on Apollo 11's flight software?

A: Margaret **Hamilton** (accept: Margaret Elaine **Heafield**)

91. What civilization used basalt from mountains in Veracruz to sculpt enormous stone heads?

A: **Olmec** civilization (accept: the **Olmecs**)

92. What author wrote about the fictional religion Earthseed in her post-apocalyptic novel *The Parable Of The Sower*?

A: Octavia **Butler**

93. What Ancient Egyptian goddess is often associated with protection and domestic life, and is usually depicted as a domestic cat?

A: **Bast**et

94. What term describes cells that allow transcription and translation to happen simultaneously, thanks to their lack of a nuclear membrane?

A: **prokaryotic** cells (accept: **prokaryotes**)

95. What kind of animal is depicted with many marble eggs in a 30-foot tall Louise Bourgeois sculpture titled *Maman*?

A: **spider**

96. What statistical procedure involves resampling one's observed data with replacement in order to estimate an estimator's distribution?

A: **bootstrap**ping

97. What position, typically a prerequisite to that of censor, was the highest elected office in the Roman Republic?

A: **consul** (accept: **consulship**)

98. What Malaysian state co-names the busiest international land border crossing in the world, alongside Singapore?

A: **Johor**

99. Which Shakespeare play featuring Leontes and Perdita includes the stage direction "Exit, pursued by a bear"?

A: *The* ***Winter's Tale***

100. What is the equivalent resistance of two resistors in parallel, each with a resistance of 4 ohms?

A: **2** ohms

END OF GAME